AUTNES
AUSTRIAN NATIONAL ELECTION STUDY

# AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2019 Documentation

(v1.0)

**AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2019 – Documentation**
(v1.0, 2020)

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# 1 Introduction

This report accompanies the Online Panel Study 2017–2019 (https://doi.org/10.11587/QDETRI) conducted by the *Austrian National Election Study* (AUTNES) and provides a detailed documentation of the data collection. The thirteen-wave panel covers the Austrian National Parliamentary Election held on 15 October 2017, the European Parliament Election held on 26 May 2019, and the Austrian National Parliamentary Election held on 29 September 2019.

## 1.1 How to cite these data

Data users are kindly asked to acknowledge the data and the accompanying release document (Documentation):

Suggested citation for the data:
Aichholzer, Julian, Julia Partheymüller, Markus Wagner, Sylvia Kritzinger, Carolina Plescia, Jakob-Moritz Eberl, Thomas Meyer, Nicolai Berk, Nico Büttner, Hajo Boomgaarden and Wolfgang C. Müller (2020). *AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2019*. Vienna: AUSSDA (doi: https://doi.org/10.11587/QDETRI).

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## 1.2 Changes in Editions

(No changes.)

# 2 Conditions of Use

## 2.1 Restrictions

The data are available for scientific use without restrictions.

## 2.2 Confidentiality

The AUTNES, its Principal Investigators, and the funding institutions neither take responsibility for the use of the data or interpretations and inferences based on their use, nor do they accept liability for indirect, consequential, or incidental damages or losses arising from use of the data.

## 2.3 Deposit Requirement

In order to facilitate exchange within the scientific community and to provide the funding agencies with essential information about the use of archival resources, users of the AUTNES data are asked to notify the AUTNES team of publications based on its data.

# 3 Study Description

## 3.1 Title and Edition

AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2019 – Documentation (Edition 1.0.0)

## 3.2 Principal Investigators

Wolfgang C. Müller, Department of Government, University of Vienna (Supply Side)
Sylvia Kritzinger, Department of Government, University of Vienna (Demand Side)
Hajo Boomgaarden, Department of Communication, University of Vienna (Media Side)

## 3.3 Funding / Acknowledgments

This study was funded by ACIER – *Austrian Cooperative Infrastructure for Electoral Research* financed by the Federal Ministry of Science, Research and Economy (BMWFW) [Scheme: Hochschulraum-Strukturmittel 2016].

### 3.4 Fieldwork agency

The fieldwork for the AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2019 was completed by "Marketagent.com online reSEARCH GmbH" (Baden, Austria), Url: http://customer.marketagent.com.

### 3.5 File Names

10096_mr_en_v1_0.pdf (Method report and codebook)
10096_qu_de_v1_0.pdf (Questionnaire German)
10096_qu_en_v1_0.pdf (Questionnaire English)
10096_vi_de_v1_0.tab (Variable identifiers and descriptions - machine-readable German)
10096_vi_en_v1_0.tab (Variable identifiers and descriptions - machine-readable English)
10096_da_de_v1_0.dta (Stata data file German)
10096_da_en_v1_0.dta (Stata data file English)
10096_da_de_v1_0.zsav (compressed SPSS data file German)
10096_da_en_v1_0.zsav (compressed SPSS data file English)
10096_om_en_v1_0.xlsx (List of variables in waves 1-13 [zipped Excel.xlsx])

### 3.6 Topics / Keywords

politics, voting, elections, Austria

## 4 Study Design

### 4.1 Sampling

The AUTNES 2017–2019 Online Panel Study surveyed respondents with access to the internet. Respondents were sampled from a pre-existing online access panel provided by Marketagent, Austria. In order to participate in the study the 2017 respondents had to be Austrian citizens and at least 16 years old or eligible to vote on Election Day 2017. They were selected (quota sample) based on the following key demographics: age, gender, gender X age, region (province), educational level, household size, and population size based on census data (Statistics Austria 2016, StatCube). Hence, the quota sample was structured to closely represent the Austrian population.

The 2017 panelists were reinvited in 2019. In addition, fresh respondents were recruited to reach quota targets and to include new respondents eligible to vote at the 2019 European Parliament election. From Wave 11 onwards, we also allow fresh respondents eligible to vote for the first time at the 2019 Austrian National Parliamentary Election to enter the survey.

We present a comparison of the target population and different waves according to core demographic characteristics in the tables below.

*Table 1: Comparison of key characteristics in the sample and population*

| | Target (2017) | Target (2019) | W1 | W2 | W3 | W4 | W5 | W6 | W7 | W8 | W9 | W10 | W11 | W12 | W13 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Male | 0.487 | 0.488 | 0.498 | 0.504 | 0.505 | 0.503 | 0.507 | 0.508 | 0.499 | 0.501 | 0.501 | 0.503 | 0.498 | 0.497 | 0.497 |
| Female | 0.513 | 0.512 | 0.502 | 0.496 | 0.495 | 0.497 | 0.493 | 0.492 | 0.501 | 0.499 | 0.499 | 0.497 | 0.502 | 0.503 | 0.503 |
| 15 – 24 years | 0.130 | 0.123 | 0.153 | 0.129 | 0.127 | 0.117 | 0.114 | 0.120 | 0.141 | 0.142 | 0.135 | 0.132 | 0.138 | 0.137 | 0.131 |
| 25 – 34 years | 0.143 | 0.143 | 0.179 | 0.170 | 0.172 | 0.159 | 0.163 | 0.162 | 0.181 | 0.169 | 0.180 | 0.175 | 0.173 | 0.171 | 0.170 |
| 35 – 44 years | 0.139 | 0.139 | 0.211 | 0.214 | 0.215 | 0.218 | 0.218 | 0.213 | 0.193 | 0.197 | 0.189 | 0.195 | 0.187 | 0.193 | 0.191 |
| 45 – 54 years | 0.190 | 0.181 | 0.220 | 0.234 | 0.234 | 0.242 | 0.241 | 0.237 | 0.213 | 0.216 | 0.210 | 0.215 | 0.213 | 0.215 | 0.216 |
| 55 – 64 years | 0.162 | 0.174 | 0.172 | 0.182 | 0.180 | 0.190 | 0.188 | 0.192 | 0.183 | 0.180 | 0.181 | 0.179 | 0.186 | 0.183 | 0.188 |
| 65 years + | 0.236 | 0.240 | 0.065 | 0.072 | 0.072 | 0.075 | 0.075 | 0.076 | 0.089 | 0.096 | 0.106 | 0.103 | 0.103 | 0.101 | 0.104 |
| Male, 15 – 24 years | 0.067 | 0.062 | 0.076 | 0.064 | 0.064 | 0.060 | 0.058 | 0.062 | 0.070 | 0.067 | 0.064 | 0.064 | 0.065 | 0.067 | 0.058 |
| Male, 25 – 34 years | 0.095 | 0.091 | 0.110 | 0.113 | 0.114 | 0.119 | 0.119 | 0.114 | 0.106 | 0.107 | 0.104 | 0.104 | 0.101 | 0.104 | 0.107 |
| Male, 35 – 44 years | 0.083 | 0.089 | 0.090 | 0.095 | 0.095 | 0.097 | 0.094 | 0.096 | 0.095 | 0.093 | 0.092 | 0.094 | 0.097 | 0.095 | 0.098 |
| Male, 45 – 54 years | 0.133 | 0.135 | 0.030 | 0.032 | 0.033 | 0.033 | 0.033 | 0.035 | 0.042 | 0.042 | 0.046 | 0.042 | 0.047 | 0.045 | 0.045 |
| Male, 55 – 64 years | 0.073 | 0.073 | 0.087 | 0.079 | 0.082 | 0.076 | 0.078 | 0.079 | 0.086 | 0.081 | 0.086 | 0.082 | 0.081 | 0.078 | 0.080 |
| Male, 65 years + | 0.070 | 0.071 | 0.107 | 0.112 | 0.114 | 0.119 | 0.119 | 0.115 | 0.098 | 0.101 | 0.096 | 0.099 | 0.094 | 0.095 | 0.100 |
| Female, 15 – 24 years | 0.095 | 0.090 | 0.110 | 0.121 | 0.120 | 0.123 | 0.123 | 0.122 | 0.108 | 0.110 | 0.105 | 0.111 | 0.112 | 0.111 | 0.110 |
| Female, 25 – 34 years | 0.080 | 0.086 | 0.083 | 0.088 | 0.086 | 0.093 | 0.095 | 0.097 | 0.088 | 0.088 | 0.090 | 0.085 | 0.089 | 0.088 | 0.091 |
| Female, 35 – 44 years | 0.103 | 0.105 | 0.035 | 0.040 | 0.039 | 0.042 | 0.043 | 0.041 | 0.048 | 0.054 | 0.060 | 0.062 | 0.056 | 0.057 | 0.059 |
| Female, 45 – 54 years | 0.063 | 0.061 | 0.077 | 0.064 | 0.062 | 0.056 | 0.056 | 0.058 | 0.070 | 0.075 | 0.070 | 0.068 | 0.072 | 0.068 | 0.073 |
| Female, 55 – 64 years | 0.069 | 0.069 | 0.093 | 0.091 | 0.090 | 0.083 | 0.085 | 0.083 | 0.094 | 0.087 | 0.094 | 0.093 | 0.092 | 0.093 | 0.090 |
| Female, 65 years + | 0.069 | 0.068 | 0.103 | 0.102 | 0.101 | 0.099 | 0.099 | 0.098 | 0.094 | 0.096 | 0.093 | 0.095 | 0.092 | 0.097 | 0.090 |
| Elementary or lower secondary school | 0.209 | 0.197 | 0.101 | 0.099 | 0.101 | 0.099 | 0.096 | 0.102 | 0.120 | 0.105 | 0.110 | 0.114 | 0.118 | 0.115 | 0.109 |
| Vocational school | 0.364 | 0.365 | 0.385 | 0.394 | 0.387 | 0.386 | 0.388 | 0.390 | 0.382 | 0.373 | 0.370 | 0.388 | 0.379 | 0.388 | 0.404 |
| Polytechnic, BMS | 0.136 | 0.133 | 0.151 | 0.156 | 0.158 | 0.149 | 0.153 | 0.151 | 0.164 | 0.155 | 0.161 | 0.157 | 0.150 | 0.150 | 0.156 |
| Upper secondary school | 0.159 | 0.161 | 0.210 | 0.198 | 0.197 | 0.204 | 0.202 | 0.200 | 0.194 | 0.211 | 0.205 | 0.196 | 0.197 | 0.197 | 0.189 |
| University degree | 0.132 | 0.144 | 0.153 | 0.153 | 0.157 | 0.163 | 0.162 | 0.157 | 0.141 | 0.156 | 0.154 | 0.145 | 0.155 | 0.151 | 0.142 |
| Vorarlberg | 0.043 | 0.043 | 0.045 | 0.042 | 0.044 | 0.042 | 0.042 | 0.041 | 0.039 | 0.038 | 0.036 | 0.036 | 0.041 | 0.037 | 0.040 |
| Tyrol | 0.085 | 0.084 | 0.083 | 0.083 | 0.084 | 0.077 | 0.078 | 0.078 | 0.074 | 0.080 | 0.078 | 0.080 | 0.085 | 0.081 | 0.084 |
| Salzburg | 0.061 | 0.061 | 0.063 | 0.066 | 0.063 | 0.062 | 0.063 | 0.060 | 0.056 | 0.054 | 0.057 | 0.055 | 0.059 | 0.057 | 0.065 |
| Styria | 0.151 | 0.151 | 0.141 | 0.141 | 0.143 | 0.153 | 0.152 | 0.146 | 0.135 | 0.140 | 0.141 | 0.145 | 0.143 | 0.136 | 0.144 |
| Carinthia | 0.068 | 0.068 | 0.066 | 0.067 | 0.067 | 0.066 | 0.065 | 0.067 | 0.066 | 0.061 | 0.059 | 0.061 | 0.063 | 0.064 | 0.062 |
| Upper Austria | 0.173 | 0.173 | 0.166 | 0.165 | 0.164 | 0.165 | 0.160 | 0.167 | 0.169 | 0.168 | 0.164 | 0.171 | 0.165 | 0.166 | 0.166 |
| Lower Austria | 0.202 | 0.204 | 0.192 | 0.190 | 0.191 | 0.191 | 0.194 | 0.191 | 0.203 | 0.200 | 0.199 | 0.196 | 0.194 | 0.194 | 0.195 |
| Vienna | 0.181 | 0.179 | 0.210 | 0.211 | 0.211 | 0.211 | 0.216 | 0.213 | 0.223 | 0.221 | 0.229 | 0.220 | 0.216 | 0.226 | 0.211 |
| Burgenland | 0.037 | 0.037 | 0.034 | 0.035 | 0.034 | 0.033 | 0.032 | 0.037 | 0.036 | 0.038 | 0.037 | 0.036 | 0.034 | 0.038 | 0.034 |
| 1 person | 0.203 | 0.209 | 0.178 | 0.188 | 0.185 | 0.181 | 0.178 | 0.179 | 0.167 | 0.170 | 0.173 | 0.168 | 0.175 | 0.167 | 0.173 |
| 2 persons | 0.319 | 0.326 | 0.327 | 0.334 | 0.330 | 0.327 | 0.332 | 0.321 | 0.316 | 0.330 | 0.336 | 0.327 | 0.340 | 0.334 | 0.339 |
| 3+ persons | 0.478 | 0.465 | 0.495 | 0.478 | 0.485 | 0.491 | 0.490 | 0.500 | 0.517 | 0.500 | 0.491 | 0.505 | 0.485 | 0.499 | 0.488 |
| Employed | 0.905 | 0.901 | 0.944 | 0.947 | 0.950 | 0.942 | 0.947 | 0.943 | 0.931 | 0.936 | 0.935 | 0.931 | 0.938 | 0.936 | 0.934 |
| Retired | 0.095 | 0.099 | 0.056 | 0.053 | 0.050 | 0.058 | 0.053 | 0.057 | 0.069 | 0.064 | 0.065 | 0.069 | 0.062 | 0.064 | 0.066 |
| Pupil/Student | 0.525 | 0.538 | 0.590 | 0.598 | 0.596 | 0.586 | 0.589 | 0.583 | 0.594 | 0.599 | 0.597 | 0.591 | 0.587 | 0.597 | 0.603 |
| Others | 0.289 | 0.297 | 0.157 | 0.170 | 0.170 | 0.160 | 0.162 | 0.167 | 0.168 | 0.172 | 0.182 | 0.182 | 0.183 | 0.178 | 0.184 |
| Migration background: No | 0.074 | 0.068 | 0.105 | 0.088 | 0.089 | 0.113 | 0.105 | 0.105 | 0.100 | 0.098 | 0.097 | 0.090 | 0.098 | 0.094 | 0.085 |
| Migration background: Yes | 0.112 | 0.098 | 0.147 | 0.144 | 0.145 | 0.141 | 0.144 | 0.146 | 0.138 | 0.131 | 0.124 | 0.137 | 0.133 | 0.130 | 0.128 |
| Vote 2013: OEVP | 0.180 | | 0.115 | 0.118 | 0.121 | 0.114 | 0.112 | | | | | | | | |

| | Target (2017) | Target (2019) | W1 | W2 | W3 | W4 | W5 | W6 | W7 | W8 | W9 | W10 | W11 | W12 | W13 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vote 2013: SPOE | 0.201 | | 0.185 | 0.195 | 0.198 | 0.192 | 0.199 | | | | | | | | |
| Vote 2013: FPOE | 0.154 | | 0.255 | 0.255 | 0.251 | 0.247 | 0.254 | | | | | | | | |
| Vote 2013: NEOS | 0.037 | | 0.045 | 0.043 | 0.046 | 0.048 | 0.046 | | | | | | | | |
| Vote 2013: GREENS | 0.093 | | 0.111 | 0.115 | 0.114 | 0.115 | 0.114 | | | | | | | | |
| Vote 2013: OTHER | 0.084 | | 0.066 | 0.066 | 0.065 | 0.067 | 0.067 | | | | | | | | |
| Vote 2013: NON-VOTER | 0.251 | | 0.224 | 0.207 | 0.204 | 0.217 | 0.206 | | | | | | | | |
| Vote 2017: OEVP | 0.249 | 0.249 | | | | | 0.182 | 0.188 | 0.182 | 0.163 | 0.164 | 0.160 | 0.166 | 0.167 | |
| Vote 2017:SPOE | 0.213 | 0.213 | | | | | 0.221 | 0.217 | 0.217 | 0.199 | 0.193 | 0.192 | 0.189 | 0.196 | |
| Vote 2017:FPOE | 0.206 | 0.206 | | | | | 0.283 | 0.276 | 0.268 | 0.243 | 0.239 | 0.234 | 0.239 | 0.242 | |
| Vote 2017:NEOS | 0.042 | 0.042 | | | | | 0.064 | 0.058 | 0.052 | 0.053 | 0.055 | 0.051 | 0.048 | 0.051 | |
| Vote 2017:PILZ/JETZT | 0.035 | 0.035 | | | | | 0.069 | 0.067 | 0.058 | 0.063 | 0.059 | 0.057 | 0.059 | 0.061 | |
| Vote 2017:GREENS | 0.030 | 0.030 | | | | | 0.034 | 0.038 | 0.037 | 0.036 | 0.039 | 0.038 | 0.040 | 0.039 | |
| Vote 2017:OTHER | 0.025 | 0.025 | | | | | 0.042 | 0.045 | 0.037 | 0.043 | 0.041 | 0.038 | 0.039 | 0.037 | |
| Vote 2017:NON-VOTER | 0.200 | 0.200 | | | | | 0.104 | 0.112 | 0.149 | 0.200 | 0.210 | 0.230 | 0.220 | 0.207 | |
| VOTE 2019: OEVP | | 0.280 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.239 | 0.242 |
| VOTE 2019: SPOE | | 0.158 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.171 | 0.174 |
| VOTE 2019: FPOE | | 0.121 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.180 | 0.177 |
| VOTE 2019: NEOS | | 0.061 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.078 | 0.074 |
| VOTE 2019: PILZ/JETZT | | 0.014 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.024 | 0.023 |
| VOTE 2019: GREENS | | 0.104 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.147 | 0.137 |
| VOTE 2019: OTHER | | 0.019 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.034 | 0.033 |
| VOTE 2019: NON-VOTER | | 0.244 | | | | | | | | | | | | 0.128 | 0.140 |
| EP VOTE 2019: OEVP | | 0.204 | | | | | | | | | | 0.177 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: SPOE | | 0.141 | | | | | | | | | | 0.170 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: FPOE | | 0.101 | | | | | | | | | | 0.168 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: NEOS | | 0.050 | | | | | | | | | | 0.075 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: PILZ/JETZT | | 0.006 | | | | | | | | | | 0.015 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: GREENS | | 0.083 | | | | | | | | | | 0.108 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: OTHER | | 0.013 | | | | | | | | | | 0.026 | | | |
| EP VOTE 2019: NON-VOTER | | 0.402 | | | | | | | | | | 0.261 | | | |
| RMSE (raw) | | | 0.048 | 0.048 | 0.048 | 0.048 | 0.049 | 0.047 | 0.043 | 0.042 | 0.040 | 0.043 | 0.039 | 0.042 | 0.042 |
| RMSE (weightd)[a)] | | | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 |
| RMSE (weightp) [b)] | | | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.001 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 |

Source for target distributions: Statistik Austria: Mikrozensus 2017 and 2019, Election results: Federal Ministry of the Interior.
a) RMSE value for demographic variables only. b) RMSE value for both demographic and political variables.

### 4.2 Field Work

The fieldwork was conducted by Marketagent within the following periods (see Table 2). Table 2 also provides the average interview length.

*Table 2. Fieldwork and interview length*

| Wave # | Fieldwork period | Interview length (in min.) |
|---|---|---|
| Wave 1 | 6 Jun. 2017 – 14 Jun. 2017 | [21] / 22 |
| Wave 2 | 26 Jul. 2017 – 10 Aug. 2017 | [20] / 21 |
| Wave 3 | 30 Aug. 2017 – 14 Sept. 2017 | [20] / 21 |
| Wave 4 | 2 Oct. 2017 – 13 Oct. 2017 | [21] / 22, *[33] / *31 |
| *15 Oct. 2017: Austrian National Parliamentary Elections* | | |
| Wave 5 | 17 Oct. 2017 – 27 Oct. 2017 | [14] / 16 |
| Wave 6 | 14 Dec. 2017 – 29 Dec. 2017 | [15] / 16, *[19] / *20 |
| Wave 7 | 25 Feb. 2019 – 12 Mar. 2019 | [25] / 24 |
| Wave 8 | 12. Apr. 2019 – 28. Apr. 2019 | [23] / 23, *[25]/*25 |
| Wave 9 | 6. May 2019 – 25. May 2019 | [15] / 16, *[23]/*23 |
| *26 May 2019: European Parliament Elections* | | |
| Wave 10 | 27. May 2019 – 16 Jun. 2019 | [25] / 25, *[30] / *28 |
| Wave 11 | 9. Sept. 2019 – 28. Sept. 2019 | [22] / 23, *[29] / *28 |
| *29 Sept. 2019: Austrian National Parliamentary Elections* | | |
| Wave 12 | 30. Sept. 2019 – 11. Oct. 2019 | [24] / 23, *[29] / *26 |
| Wave 13 | 10. Jan. 2020 – 24. Jan. 2020 | [19] 19, *[21] / *21 |

(Note: Interview length denotes [median] / mean, excluding interviews > 60 min, *fresh respondents)

### 4.3 Panel participation

Respondents were asked and incentivized with € 2 to participate in each wave of the panel.

The invitation for necessary "fresh" panelists (if the sample is not sufficiently large, $n < 3000$) is sent out one week after field-work starts. Only panelists from wave 1 and fresh respondents from later waves were invited and reminded of participation in all subsequent waves. Otherwise, respondents who missed a panel wave were not invited any more. All respondents who participated in the previous wave were also invited to participate in the subsequent wave.

Table 3 shows that gross sample sizes and response rates per wave. The variables **panelpat** and **w*_panelist** inform about the individual pattern of panel participation and participation in each wave, respectively.

*Table 3. Sample sizes and response rates*

| | W1 | W2 | W3 | W4 | W5 | W6 | W7 | W8 | W9 | W10 | W11 | W12 | W13 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Gross samples sizes (incl. cases excluded ex-post)** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| n responded (incl. cases deleted ex-post) | 4103 | 3183 | 3035 | 3224 | 3109 | 3101 | 3144 | 3222 | 3266 | 3118 | 3054 | 3147 | 3166 | |
| n responded from prev. waves | | 3183 | 3035 | 2908 | 3109 | 2935 | 2214 | 2521 | 3126 | 2926 | 2900 | 3040 | 2922 | |
| n responded fresh invites | 4103 | | | 316 | | 166 | 930 | 701 | 140 | 192 | 203 | 107 | 244 | |
| Resp. from prev. waves contacted (invites) | | 4103 | 4103 | 4103 | 4103 | 4103 | 4195 | 3128 | 5025 | 5126 | 5731 | 5904 | 4638 | |
| Fresh Resp. contacted (invites) | 45341 | | | 3590 | | 316 | 19239 | 7351 | 817 | 4607 | 8557 | 2957 | 10323 | |
| **Response rates** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| RR Resp. from prev. waves | | 77.6% | 74.0% | 70.9% | 75.8% | 71.5% | 52.8% | 80.6% | 62.2% | 57.1% | 50.6% | 51.5% | 63.0% | |
| RR Fresh invited Resp. | 9.0% | | | 8.8% | | 52.5% | 4,8% | 9.5% | 17.1% | 4.2% | 2.3% | 3.6% | 2.4% | |
| n excluded ex-post (fieldwork company criteria) | 61 | 26 | 16 | 37 | 54 | 21 | 16 | 68 | 61 | 57 | 51 | 78 | 103 | |
| n excluded ex-post (socio-demographic checks) | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 62 |
| n excluded (non-eligible resp.) | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 27 |
| **n finally used (without excl. cases) = Reference** | **4000** | **3122** | **2980** | **3144** | **3015** | **2980** | **3085** | **3114** | **3158** | **3016** | **3012** | **3098** | **3024** | |
| **Total sample** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | **6624** |

*Note: Response Rates are only seemingly lower in the 2019 panel because of the inclusion of 2017 panelists in the calculation and their lower re-interview rates. In W8 we cannot differentiate invites of 2017 panelists from fresh respondents; the response rate for panelists therefore gets inflated.*

## 5 Data Cleaning

### 5.1 Data protection

All information on postal codes (**sd25, sd25_y19**), political districts (**poldis, poldis_y19**) and the regional constituency (**regwk, regwk_y19**) were removed from the data set for reasons of data protection. However, postal codes were used to add the categorized population number of the municipality (**popnum, popnum_y19**) to the data set.

We also removed the date of birth (**sd2x1, sd2x1_y19**). However, a variable capturing the age of the respondent on Election Day is available in the data set (**age, age_y19**).

Morevover, we removed the names of political discussants from the data file and replaced them with numerical id variables (**w2_q44t_id, w2_q45x1t_id, w2_q45x2t_id, w4_q77t_id, w4_q78x1t_id, w4_q78x2t_id, w6_q45t_id, w6_q46x2t_id, w6_q46x1t_id**) to anonymize the data.

Finally, we recoded the following variables for reasons of data protection:

| Variable | Variable Label | Original Values | Recoded Version |
|---|---|---|---|
| **sd7**<br>**sd7_y19** | HIGHEST LEVEL OF EDUCATION | 1 did not attend school<br>2 did not finish any school<br>3 elementary school or less<br>4 primary school/secondary education first stage<br>5 special school<br>6 polytechnic institute<br>7 vocational training/school<br>8 vocational middle school<br>9 AHS with diploma<br>10 BHS with diploma<br>11 university-related college<br>12 College<br>13 Bachelor<br>14 Magister/Master<br>15 Doctorate/PhD<br>16 other | 3 did not attend/finish school/elementary school or less<br>4 primary school/secondary education first stage<br>6 polytechnic institute<br>7 vocational training/school<br>8 vocational middle school<br>9 AHS with diploma<br>10 BHS with diploma<br>11 university-related college 12 College<br>13 Bachelor<br>14 Magister/Master<br>15 Doctorate/PhD<br>16 other |
| **sd8**<br>**sd8_y19** | RELIGIOUS AFFILIATION | 1 Roman-Catholic church<br>2 Protestant church<br>3 Islamic religious community<br>4 Islamic-Alevi religious community<br>5 Christian-orthodox church<br>6 Jewish religious community<br>7 other<br>8 none | 1 Roman-Catholic church<br>2 Protestant church<br>3 Islamic religious community<br>5 Christian-orthodox church<br>7 other<br>8 none |
| **sd18**<br>**sd18_y19** | Country of birth, respondent | 1 Austria<br>2 Germany<br>3 Turkey<br>4 Serbia<br>5 Croatia<br>6 Bosnia<br>7 Slovenia<br>8 Poland<br>9 Czech Republic<br>10 Russia<br>11 Hungary<br>12 other country | 1 Austria<br>2 Germany<br>3 Bosnia, Croatia, Serbia<br>4 Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary<br>5 Other country |

| Variable | Variable Label | Original Values | Recoded Version |
|---|---|---|---|
| **sd19**<br>**sd19_y19** | Country of birth, mother | 1 Austria<br>2 Germany<br>3 Turkey<br>4 Serbia<br>5 Croatia<br>6 Bosnia<br>7 Slovenia<br>8 Poland<br>9 Czech Republic<br>10 Russia<br>11 Hungary<br>12 other country | 1 Austria<br>2 Germany<br>3 Turkey<br>4 Bosnia, Croatia, Serbia<br>5 Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary<br>6 Other country |
| **sd20**<br>**sd20_y19** | Country of birth | 1 Austria<br>2 Germany<br>3 Turkey<br>4 Serbia<br>5 Croatia<br>6 Bosnia<br>7 Slovenia<br>8 Poland<br>9 Czech Republic<br>10 Russia<br>11 Hungary<br>12 other country | 1 Austria<br>2 Germany<br>3 Turkey<br>4 Bosnia, Croatia, Serbia<br>5 Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary<br>6 Other country |

### 5.2 Quality assurance and excluded respondents

We excluded some cases due to quality issues.

1.) Respondents were excluded who exhibited very short response times (interview duration) as well as aberrant response patterns (straight-lining) as identified by the fieldwork company Marketagent. The number of cases is listed in Table 4.
2.) Respondents were excluded if the age / year of birth of the respondent deviated by 2 years (or more) and if gender of the respondent changed (at least once), which was measured at wave 1, wave 3, wave 4 and in wave7 to wave 13. Hence, cases were deleted if both conditions applied. These were $n$ = 39 cases in total.
3.) By mistake $n$ = 23 non-citizens and $n$ = 4 respondents below the age of 16 were included in the fresh sample of wave 6 (in total $n$ = 27), but were not interviewed. These cases were excluded.
4.) Additionally, there were $n$ = 2 respondents with values for age in years > 100. These were defined as missing in age (recoded as = .).
5.) One respondent entered an implausibly large value for the variable household size (sd5). The entry was recoded to missing.

The dataset also includes attention check questions (**w1_q27x5** and **w2_q24x5**, which could be used to identify respondents with lower response quality. However, we refrained from excluding respondents who failed these filter questions.

### 5.3 Variable format and missing values

All standard socio demographic variables (both for panel and fresh respondents) are designated by **sd*** (2017) and **sd*_y19** when the sociodemographic questions were updated in 2019.

All other questions have the following standard format:

*Table 4. Format of variable names*

| | Wave # | fresh respondents | question # | item # | text/string |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| abbreviation | w* | f | _q* | x* | t |
| example | 2 | | 24 | 5 | |
| | | | = **w2_q24x5** | | |

For most variables missing values were coded as follows:

77 = do not know party/person
88 = don't know
99 = refused

## 6 Weighting of data

The dataset includes several weighting variables which can be used for post-stratification adjustment to known population distributions. For all waves (1-13) two weighting variables are provided:

- demographic weight: **w*_weightd**
  The "demographic" weight adjusts to known socio-demographic population distributions only (see Table 1).
- demographic + political weight: **w*_weightp**
  The "political" weight further adjusts for turnout and vote choice marginals using reported voting behavior in the last national election (2013/2017/2019) or last European election (2019), respectively (see also Table 1).

Target distributions are based on Micro Census data 2017 and 2019 (Statistics Austria StatCube, retrieved August 2020) using the Austrian population aged ≥ 15 having Austrian citizenship as reference population, i.e., a total of approx. 6,316,000 residents (2017) / 7,562,000 (2019). Official election results are provided by the Austrian Ministry of the Interior (http://wahl13.bmi.gv.at, https://wahl17.bmi.gv.at, https://wahl19.bmi.gv.at/).
For computing the weighting variables we used the STATA module "ipfweight". Computation of all weighting variables was limited to a minimum value of 0.20 and a maximum value of 5.00. Missing values in the target variables were weighted neutrally.